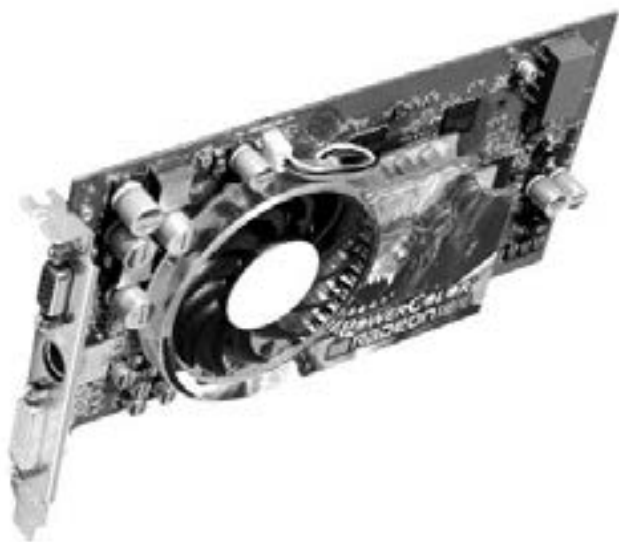




3.2 Playing With Cards

A computer is made up of various components that contribute in one way or the other to its usability, and matter in the final experience of the user. For instance, if you try watching a DVD movie on an old video card such as the Cirrus Logic or SiS 6215 with a maximum of 2 MB of video memory, you'll end up watching a slideshow rather than a movie. In some cases, the player will crash with an error message saying there isn't enough video memory. The point is that there is always a need to upgrade not only the CPU and the motherboard, but also the other installed components as and when needed, since each of these is designed specifically to cater to some segment of your computer usage.

Let's look at the various types of cards that are installed on a computer's motherboard.

Before we take a look at the cards themselves, we will need to understand a bit about the slots that they fit into.